What's new

Tricki now live

Terence Tao · 16 April 2009

https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2009/04/16/tricki-now-live/

tao2typ · converted to Typst 2026-10-14 (UTC)

From Tim Gowers' blog comes the announcement that the Tricki – a wiki for various tricks and strategies for proving mathematical results – is now live. (My own articles for the Tricki are also on this blog; also Ben Green has written up an article on using finite fields to prove results about infinite fields which is loosely based on my own post on the topic, which is in turn based on an article of Serre.) It seems to already be growing at a reasonable rate, with many contributors.

Comments (13)



anon · 16 April 2009

Nice, but I hope there are more algebraic articles to come.



bengreen · 17 April 2009

I hope there will be more algebraic articles too. In fact part of my thinking in writing a couple of (loosely) algebraic articles was that more expert readers would be so affronted by my ignorance that they could not help but make corrections and supply further discussion. I hope to see that happening!



gowers · 17 April 2009

I too very much hope that there will be more algebraic articles, and my motivation for writing a couple of articles on group theory was much the same as the motivation that Ben expresses above. I'm glad to see that Henry Wilton has already contributed a group theory article.



Terence Tao · 17 April 2009

In that spirit, I just contributed another group theory article to the Tricki:

http://www.tricki.org/article/First_pretend_that_a_normal_subgroup_is_trivial



Anon · 19 April 2009

Dear Professor Tao,

you (or someone else) could write a short article on "making divergent expressions into precise proofs" explaining what you meant in your blog entry on Tate's thesis about using distributions.



Terence Tao · 20 April 2009

Dear Anon,

There is some discussion on this at the tricki article

http://www.tricki.org/article/Create_an_epsilon_of_room

particularly in Example 5. (For the manipulations involving adeles, one would probably want to perform some regularisations based on gaussians; such computations are not yet on that tricki article, but presumably one could request a computation there.)

Tricki opens its doors // La Tricki abre sus puertas « chimathera · 21 April 2009
[...] More information available at: Tricki now fully live – Gowers Tricki now live – Tao [...]

 **JoseBrox** · 21 April 2009

Hi Terry!

I trackbacked you at my new wordpress blog (chimathera) and mentioned you in my first post as an example of a mathematician who uses (and uses well!) the "Tricki techniques". I hope you don't mind!

Regards, Jose Brox

How to Write a Really Good Research Paper « Successful Researcher · 1 May 2009
[...] Mathematicians can also make use of the classical text How to write mathematics by Paul R. Halmos. Another potentially very promising tool for mathematicians is Tricki (the wiki of math tricks and techniques) whose aims and scope are discussed at the blogs of the Fields medalists Tim Gowers and Terence Tao, see e.g. here and here. [...]

Trucos y consejos para demostraciones Matemáticas · 30 July 2009
[...] niveles superiores, es más, el lanzamiento de Tricki.org lo conocí hace unos meses gracias a un post del Dr. Terry Tao (Medalla Fields en el 2006, algo así como el Novel en Matemáticas), desde entonces la cantidad de [...]

Tricki Math Methods Website | New Math Done Right · 20 May 2012
[...] Terry Tao announcement on Tricki now live. [...]

 **Anonymous** · 25 May 2018

It seems that Tricki is not active anymore.

 **gowers** · 27 May 2018

That's basically correct, and it's a phenomenon I hope to learn from. I think the fundamental problem with it was that it was quite hard to make a really good contribution to it: for a website to take off, there needs to be a lower bar to participation.